Her Next Chapter

After decades of building careers and leading organisations, women leaders face a new balancing act: staying professionally relevant, finding opportunities, and making room for a life beyond the corner office BY **MAMTA SHARMA**

AFTER DECADES OF building businesses, leading teams, and making decisions at the highest levels, what comes next for women who step away from the corner office?

Some take their experience to boardrooms and advisory roles; others turn to entrepreneurship, mentoring, teaching or social initiatives.

For many, this phase also offers the freedom to rediscover personal interests, spend more time with family and friends, and choose how they want to work and live.

The transition is about more than retirement. It is a chance to reassess where their expertise can make a difference and how they define success beyond a corporate title.

Roopa Kudva, former MD and CEO of CRISIL, moved into impact investing before making more room for writing and other interests.

Aruna Jayanthi, former Capgemini executive and a member of the supervisory board of Michelin Group, combines board responsibilities with advising start-ups and a social enterprise.

Former State Bank of India chairperson Arundhati Bhattacharya took on a new leadership role at Salesforce as the Chairperson and CEO of Salesforce India during the Covid-19 lockdown.

Ritu Anand, former Chief Leadership & Diversity Officer and Senior Vice President HR at TCS, is exploring opportunities across industries, while Raju Mistry, former global CHRO at Grasim, Jubilant and Cipla, has become an entrepreneur.

For these leaders, the transition has meant rethinking not just what they do next, but what they want from work and life.